

HootSuite

For all the social networking junkies out there, the search for the most powerful social networking app is over - introducing the Hootsuite (www.hootsuite.com). We should probably be discussing the smaller

HootSuite is an online service that integrates all your social networking accounts from Twitter, Facebook, LinkedIn, Ping.fm, MySpace, WordPress, and Foursquare. It can even connect to multiple accounts from each service.



Connecting to social networks on HootSuite

list of what you can't do with this awesome web application!

It is not uncommon to have multiple social networking

accounts today; there are those who stick to Facebook or Twitter or Orkut, but chances are you have accounts on most of them. If you have your own blog or website, or you work for a company which has one, you probably have Twitter accounts / Facebook pages for those as well.

HootSuite makes managing such accounts very easy. Not only can you add multiple accounts, but you can add multiple team members to your social networking accounts so they can post messages on your behalf. This kind of setup is perfect for organizations which want multiple people to post on their Twitter account, since Twitter as of now does not provide such functionality - although it is planned.

For a web application, HootSuite has a very rich interface, with TweetDeck-like columns, and mouse-over actions for messages. It also adds another dimension by adding tabs

above columns, so you can have groups of columns arranged inside tabs. By default it creates a new tab for each social networking account you add, however you are free to mix and match.

Each tab can have its own refresh rate so more important active tabs can get greater attention. You can even set a tab to update manually if you want. Tabs, and columns can both be rearranged easily by simply dragging and dropping, and column widths can be changed so that you don't need to scroll horizontally. The UI is very flexible and you can often forget that you are using a web-application in a browser.

HootSuite offers many features you'll find in most desktop and web Twitter / social networking clients, such as shrinking Tweets, auto-shortening URLs, adding images to tweets, etc. Some of its best features of the app though are those not found in other Twitter cli-

Google TV: TV meets Web

Google has finally made its foray from the small screen to the big screen

Google TV is an effort to finally bring the Web to the TV set. It's certainly not a new idea, but till now web sites have never been designed with TV sets in mind, limiting the usefulness of such devices.

What Google wants to bring to the TV experience, is the power and flexibility of the web, but in a form factor that can really be enjoyed on TV screens. The aim is to make watching your TV a social experience, just like web videos. Nowadays we want to watch stuff which has a little more personal relevance, stuff that our friends like and post.

Google TV also brings the power of search to your TV set. With Google TV you can simply search for what you

are looking for in the embedded browser, instead of changing channels.

Google TV will be based on the open-source Android OS with the Google Chrome browser. Google will soon release a TV SDK for developing Android applications designed for TV sets, and the Android Market shall host such applications. Google is encouraging developers to start considering TVs as possible web interfaces for websites as well.

Google is also embracing Adobe Flash in their Chrome browser for TVs and set-tops, which will feature Adobe Flash Player 10.1 with support for hardware accelerated playback of video content on



the web.

To bring this to realisation, Google has tied up with Sony, which will be making TV sets and Blu-Ray players which include support for Google TV; and Logitech, which will release set-top boxes for use with current TVs.

Television needed more than just a push up in the resolution of the content, but also the quality and relevance. Google TV seems to be an effort which gives it just the right push.